Pemetrexed + Cisplatin

Both chemotherapy medicines are planned on Day 1 of a 21-day cycle. For pleural mesothelioma, the source describes up to 4–6 cycles. For advanced non-squamous NSCLC, it describes 4–6 combination cycles followed, when appropriate, by a separate pemetrexed maintenance plan (NCCP00222). The selected preoperative nivolumab combination uses three cycles and a separate immunotherapy plan (NCCP00849). Your team confirms which course applies and may stop or change it earlier.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Ears / hearing

Cisplatin

Report tinnitus or hearing change promptly; describe any existing problem before starting.

2 Mouth

Pemetrexed

Mouth ulcers or painful swallowing can limit eating and drinking. Seek advice early.

3 Chest / breathing

Both chemotherapy medicines

New breathlessness, wheeze or chest pain needs urgent assessment; do not assume it is an expected side effect.

4 Kidneys / fluids

Both chemotherapy medicines

Report reduced urine, inability to drink, swelling or dehydration. Kidney tests guide treatment.

5 Stomach / bowel

Both chemotherapy medicines

Use prescribed anti-sickness medicines. Severe vomiting, diarrhoea or poor intake needs urgent advice.

6 Hands / feet

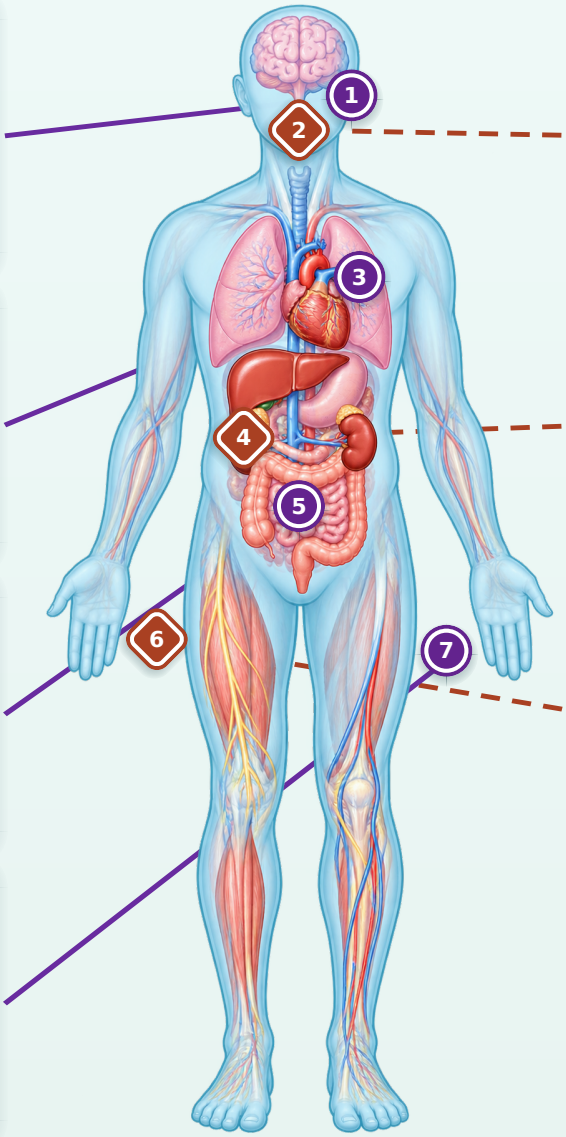
Cisplatin

Report tingling, numbness or difficulty with buttons, balance or walking; symptoms can persist.

7 Skin / blood counts

Both chemotherapy medicines

Report a spreading rash, unusual bruising or bleeding. Fever or sudden illness needs urgent advice.



Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

> Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Pemetrexed

- Low blood counts, infection and bleeding
- Nausea, vomiting and fatigue
- Mouth soreness and diarrhoea
- Kidney problems
- Allergic or infusion reactions
- Skin rash; rarely serious skin reactions
- Rare serious lung inflammation

Cisplatin

- Low blood counts, infection and bleeding
- Nausea, vomiting and fatigue
- Mouth soreness and diarrhoea
- Kidney problems
- Allergic or infusion reactions
- Hearing changes or tinnitus, which can persist
- Numbness or tingling, which can persist
- Electrolyte changes and need for hydration

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Folic acid every day

The source uses 350–1000 micrograms daily: at least five doses during the seven days before the first pemetrexed, throughout treatment and for 21 days after the last pemetrexed. Follow your own prescription and tell the team about missed doses.

Vitamin B12 injection

The source uses 1000 micrograms into a muscle during the week before the first pemetrexed, then every three cycles. Later injections can be on treatment day. Confirm who books them.

One steroid schedule

Pemetrexed rash prevention uses dexamethasone-equivalent 4 mg twice daily on the day before, day of and day after treatment. The anti-sickness plan also uses steroids. Your prescriber/pharmacist must provide one reconciled schedule; do not add two courses together.

Preventing and treating sickness

This cisplatin combination has high sickness risk. Take prevention medicines as prescribed even when you feel well, and keep the team's rescue plan available. The usual high-risk reference includes olanzapine; ask about sleepiness, falls and interactions.

Fluids and kidney protection

Ask for an individual drinking plan, especially with heart or kidney problems. Report inability to drink or reduced urine. Cisplatin needs supervised fluids before and after treatment; additional salts may be prescribed.

Medicines and self-care

Check all prescriptions, painkillers, supplements and vaccines with the oncology team. Some anti-inflammatory medicines can affect pemetrexed clearance; do not start or stop them on this guide's authority. Follow mouth-care and infection advice.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00317/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.